

Reading into Writing



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

Assessment



- At the end of the course, you will have a 'Reading into Writing' assessment (Paper B).
- You will be given extracts from three texts and will have to use the texts to write a response to an essay question (approximately 600 words)
- You will have two hours to complete Paper B.
- Each week, you will practice and receive feedback.

This assessment (Paper B: Reading into Writing) will contribute to your marks for:

- a) Reading (60 out of 90 marks – the other 30 come from the assignment)
- b) Writing (40 out of 90 marks – the other 50 marks come from:
 - Paper A: Listening into Writing (10 marks)
 - The Assignment (40 marks)

Marking criteria for reading



This focuses on:

- Text use
- Synthesis
- Selection
- Paraphrasing

Marking criteria for reading



Papers awarded the highest marks will:

- Make excellent use of the texts to support argument / points.
- Be highly successful at adapting the content of texts to suit the purpose of writing.
- Be highly successfully at identifying common themes and links within and across the multiple texts.
- Demonstrate excellent quotation, paraphrasing, summarising skills

Marking criteria for writing



This focuses on:

- Task fulfilment
- Structure
- Language Style & Range
- Language Accuracy

Marking criteria for writing



Papers awarded the highest marks will:

- Fulfil all task requirements and present an excellent response to the essay question.
- Sequence information and ideas very logically and effectively with very clear progression, an extensive range of cohesive devices and highly effective paragraphing.
- Use a wide range of stylistically appropriate grammar and vocabulary to convey precise meanings flexibly and fluently.
- Have the majority of sentences error free; any errors which do occur will be minor and not impede communication or create difficulty for the reader.

Marking criteria



You can see the full marking criteria on Moodle



Reading into Writing



- Each week you will have practice.
- This week you will receive the question and text extracts in advance. We will give you some feedback but not an indicative mark.
- In weeks 2-5, you will not receive the question or text extracts in advance. We will give you feedback and an indicative mark.

Week One: Question



This week, you will have to write a response to this question:

Last year, 3.96 billion people used social media, which is more than half the world's population. Is this cause for concern?

Discuss the question in a group.

- How might you answer the question?
- How could you structure your answer?

Week Three: Texts



You will be given texts adapted from three sources:

1. Esteban Ortiz-Ospina (2019) - “Are Facebook and other social media platforms bad for our well-being?” Published online at OurWorldInData.org. Retrieved from: 'https://ourworldindata.org/social-media-wellbeing' [Online Resource]
2. Kross, E., Verduyn, P., Sheppes, G., Costello, C. K., Jonides, J., & Ybarra, O. (2021). Social media and well-being: Pitfalls, progress, and next steps. *Trends in cognitive sciences*, 25(1), 55-66.
3. Lee, A. Y., & Hancock, J. T. (2024). Social media mindsets: A new approach to understanding social media use and psychological well-being. *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication*, 29(1)

How should you reference these texts in your essay?

Week Three: Texts



1. Esteban Ortiz-Ospina (2019) - “Are Facebook and other social media platforms bad for our well-being?”
Published online at OurWorldInData.org.
Retrieved from:
'<https://ourworldindata.org/social-media-wellbeing>' [Online Resource]
2. Kross, E., Verduyn, P., Sheppes, G., Costello, C. K., Jonides, J., & Ybarra, O. (2021). Social media and well-being: Pitfalls, progress, and next steps. *Trends in cognitive sciences*, 25(1), 55-66.
3. Lee, A. Y., & Hancock, J. T. (2024). Social media mindsets: A new approach to understanding social media use and psychological well-being. *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication*, 29(1)

Ortiz-Ospina (2019) argues...
OR
(Ortiz-Ospina, 2019)

Kross et al (2021) argue...
OR
(Kross et al, 2021)

Lee and Hancock (2024)
argue...
OR
(Lee & Hancock, 2024)

Summarising, paraphrasing and quoting...



- We will be discussing summarising, paraphrasing and quoting in your 'Academic Writing & Assignment' classes next week.
- We will also be discussing how to avoid plagiarism, how to synthesise texts and how to be critical/analytical.
- So, this week, do your best but don't worry too much. The focus this week is more on the criteria for 'writing' than the criteria for 'reading'.

Secondary referencing



- One thing to be aware of is secondary referencing
- A secondary reference is when you refer to someone cited within another source, i.e. you have not read the original work.
- Ideally, you should always try and read the original source so that you can review the work first-hand.
- If you are not able to, it is acceptable to reference it as a secondary reference, following the format below.

(Haidt, 2022, cited in Lee & Hancock, 2024)

Secondary referencing



You did not read this text



(Haidt, 2022, cited in Lee & Hancock, 2024)



You read this text

Secondary referencing



Imagine you have read this article:

Lee, A. Y., & Hancock, J. T. (2024). Social media mindsets: A new approach to understanding social media use and psychological well-being. *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication*, 29(1)

And you want to refer to research done by Beyens (below)

When considering the influence of social media use on affective well-being, for example, Beyens et al. (2021) found that engaging with social media improved well-being for 26% of adolescents, harmed well-being in another 28%, and did not influence the well-being of 45%.

How would you write a secondary reference?

Secondary referencing



You would write the secondary reference as below:

Beyens et al (2021, cited in Lee & Hancock, 2024) claim...
integral/narrative reference

OR

.... (Beyens et al, 2021, cited in Lee & Hancock, 2024)
non-integral/parenthetical reference

Task



- Now, read the text extracts and think about how you can use them in your essay.
- Compare your thoughts with a partner.

